



Tips & Tricks



Count the number of SSH commands

The following command will find the number of the SSH connections from a local to a remote machine:

```
ss | grep -vE 'State' | awk '{print $1 ~ /^.*Local$4$' ~ "to"
"Remote$5$"} | grep -e ssh | wc -l
```

The following command will print out the SSH connections from the local to the remote machine:

```
ss | grep -vE 'State' | awk '{print $1 ~ /^.*Local$4$' ~ "to"
"Remote$5$"} | grep -e ssh
```

—Shreyas Parikh, shreyu82@gmail.com



Investigation of sockets

The following command will display the names of the ports that are connected to a remote server:

```
ss | grep -vE 'State' | awk '{print $5}' | cut -d'/' -f2 | sort | uniq
```

The command will print only the established port names.

—Shreyas Parikh, shreyu82@gmail.com



How to record a Linux session

If you want to record your Linux session with the commands given and their outputs, use the script command as follows:

```
root@localhost# script <filename.log>
```

It basically forks a new shell so that if you want to stop a session recording, just type exit or press Ctrl+d. You can find the recorded session in the ~/session.log file.

Another interesting use of the script utility is redirecting your typed characters to another user's

terminal — someone who is logged on to Telnet/SSH. To do this, you must learn the devpts number of that person (which can be obtained from the output of the who command). And if it is 7, for example, then the following command...

```
root@localhost# script /dev/pts/7
```

...will redirect all typed characters to that user's terminal window.

—Selvaraj, selvaraj2005@gmail.com



Skip or bypass a fsck

Generally, fsck is run automatically at boot time when the system detects that a filesystem is in an inconsistent state, indicating a non-graceful shutdown, such as a crash or power loss.

We can bypass it on the next reboot by the following three methods:

- 1) Using the shutdown command

```
# shutdown -f now (here -f option will skip the fsck.)
# shutdown -F now (here -F option will force the fsck on next
reboot)
```

- 2) By editing the kernel parameter in /boot/grub/grub.conf (or menu.lst). Open grub.conf or menu.lst and find the kernel line. Put fastboot at the end of this line. An example kernel line is shown below:

```
kernel /vmlinuz-2.6.18-92.1.22.el5 ro root=LABEL=/ console=ttyO
console=ttyS1,19200n8 fastboot
```

- 3) By updating /etc/fstab file. You will see two numbers at the end of the line for each partition. Change the second number to a 0 (zero digit). This will have the system mount the partition, but will not run a check when booting. If the sixth field is neither present